Source E

From a booklet published by the Israeli government in 1969.

In 1966–7 terrorism had been increased by the Arab states to a fearsome peak. Syrian radio continuously broadcast claims of the havoc and destruction caused by Arab terrorists in Israel. The Syrian Prime Minister said at the United Nations in October 1966: 'Syria will never retreat from the popular liberation war to recover Palestine.'

(a) (i) What does the author of Source A mean by 'infiltration into Israel from Syrian-based camps'? (2 marks)
(ii) What is the significance of what the Syrian Prime Minister is quoted as saying in Source E? (3 marks)
(b) In what ways do Sources B and D support the views expressed in Source A? (6 marks)
(c) With reference to their origins and purpose, assess the value and limitations of Sources C and E for the historian studying the causes of the Six-Day War. (6 marks)
(d) Using these sources and your own knowledge, assess the causes of the Six-Day War. (8 marks)

Exam tips

Read pages 45–50 again.

(a) (i) This source is referring to attacks by Fatah from Palestinian refugee camps in Syria.
(ii) According to this Israeli government source, the Syrian leader is saying that Syria will continue to support the 'popular liberation war to recover Palestine', probably referring to the PLO campaign, led by Fatah guerrillas, to win back all of the land lost in 1948–9. That would mean the elimination of the state of Israel. He is making the claim in the very public international arena of the UN.

(b) Source A writes of increasing attacks by Syria and of Palestinian 'infiltration' of Israel. The author refers to the shelling of Israeli villages in the demilitarised zones. In Source B the Israeli leader writes of sending tractors into the demilitarised areas, similar to Source A's reference to 'farming operations' in those areas, but suggests that the Israelis deliberately provoked the Syrians into shooting by ploughing in areas 'where it wasn't possible to do anything' and telling 'the tractor to advance further' so that the Syrians 'would get annoyed and shoot'. By contrast, Source A makes no mention of any Israeli blame. Both refer to the use of Israeli aircraft but only Source A implies that it was for purely defensive purposes. Source D shows a Fatah member, one of the PLO fighters, receiving military training, presumably for attacks on Israel. This would seem to support Source A's reference to 'infiltration into Israel from Syrian-based camps', as we know Syria supported the PLO campaign to regain Palestine. However, there is no indication that Fatah fighters were involved in the shelling that Source A refers to.